

Project Human Resource Management

SECTION: Purpose

Project HR management covers the processes needed to identify, acquire, develop, and manage the project team so that project objectives are achieved effectively.

SECTION: Key Processes

1. **Human Resource Planning** — identifying and documenting roles, responsibilities, required skills, reporting relationships, and creating a staffing management plan.
2. **Acquiring the Project Team** — obtaining the human resources needed, which may involve negotiating with functional managers (in a matrix organization) or hiring externally.
3. **Developing the Project Team** — improving competencies, team interaction, and the overall team environment to enhance performance.
4. **Managing the Project Team** — tracking team member performance, providing feedback, resolving issues, and coordinating changes.

SECTION: Organizational Charts and Role Definition Tools

- **Organization Chart (OBS)**: hierarchical view of reporting relationships.
- **Responsibility Assignment Matrix (RAM)**: maps project resources to work; the most common form is the **RACI chart**:
 - **Responsible** — does the work.
 - **Accountable** — owns the outcome, signs off (only one A per task).
 - **Consulted** — provides input before/during the work.
 - **Informed** — kept updated on progress/outcome.
- **Position Descriptions**: text-based role/responsibility descriptions, useful for detailed roles.

SECTION: Tuckman's Stages of Team Development

1. **Forming** — team meets, is polite, roles unclear.
2. **Storming** — conflict emerges as personalities and working styles clash.
3. **Norming** — team begins to work together, trust builds, norms established.
4. **Performing** — team operates as a cohesive, high-functioning unit.
5. **Adjourning** — team disbands after project completion.

Understanding which stage a team is in helps a PM choose the right leadership style (e.g. more directive during storming, more delegative during performing).

SECTION: Motivation Theories Commonly Applied in PM

- **Maslow's Hierarchy of Needs:** physiological → safety → social → esteem → self-actualization; a PM should ensure lower needs (fair pay, safe environment) are met before expecting motivation from higher-level factors.
- **Herzberg's Two-Factor Theory:** distinguishes *hygiene factors* (salary, working conditions — their absence causes dissatisfaction but their presence doesn't necessarily motivate) from *motivators* (achievement, recognition, growth — these drive real motivation).
- **McGregor's Theory X and Theory Y:** Theory X assumes workers are inherently unmotivated and need close supervision; Theory Y assumes workers are self-motivated and thrive with autonomy.

SECTION: Conflict Management

Common sources of project conflict: schedules, priorities, resources, technical opinions, and personality clashes. Thomas-Kilmann conflict-handling modes:

- **Collaborating** (win-win, address underlying interests — best for important, non-time-critical issues)
- **Compromising** (partial satisfaction for both sides)
- **Smoothing/Accommodating** (emphasize agreement, downplay differences)
- **Forcing/Competing** (win-lose, PM imposes a decision — fast but can damage relationships)
- **Withdrawing/Avoiding** (postpone or ignore — useful to cool down, but doesn't resolve the issue)

SECTION: Leadership vs Management in Projects

- **Management** focuses on planning, organizing, and controlling to consistently produce results.
- **Leadership** focuses on setting direction, aligning people, and inspiring/motivating them toward a vision.

A good PM typically blends both, adjusting style (directive, coaching, supportive, delegating) to team maturity.

SECTION: Common Exam Angles

- Fill in or interpret a RACI chart for a given scenario.
- Identify which Tuckman stage a described team is in.
- Match a conflict scenario to the appropriate Thomas-Kilmann mode.
- Distinguish hygiene factors from motivators in a Herzberg-style scenario.